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US equities tumble as tech leads broad sell-off, yields slip

A 5-minute read of yesterday's US session and today's catalysts — what to watch before pre-market opens at 21:30 HKT.

2-3 page read · Topics: Macro · Geopolitics · Earnings

TL;DR

The S&P 500 closed at 7,580.07, down -1.82%, while the Nasdaq 100 fell -3.46% on a wave of tech weakness led by **NVDA** (-4.22%). The 10-year Treasury yield slipped to 4.93%, easing pressure on rate-sensitive sectors.

Energy rallied on higher crude, with XLE up +1.91%. Volatility spiked, VIX jumping +12.91%, signaling heightened risk appetite. Investors eye upcoming earnings and Fed minutes for direction.

US Session Recap

INDEX / ASSET	CLOSE	CHANGE	NOTE
S&P 500	7,580.07	-1.82%	
Dow Jones	51,770.31	-1.09%	
Nasdaq 100	28,384.85	-3.46%	
Russell 2000	2,811.84	-1.66%	
VIX	19.42	+12.91%	Volatility surge
10Y Yield	4.93%	-1.20%	
WTI Crude	104.12	+2.08%	

Top large-cap movers

TICKER	CLOSE	CHANGE
AVGO	326.08	-5.48%
NVDA	204.64	-4.22%
GS	894.55	-3.58%
XLK	179.51	-4.89%

Spotlight

METRIC	VALUE
Company	**NVDA**
Q3 Revenue	30.2 bn
YoY Growth	-8.5%
EPS	3.12
Guidance	-12% YoY

NVDA missed revenue expectations and cut its FY guidance, dragging the broader tech sector. The miss amplified concerns over demand slowdown in AI-driven hardware, prompting the steepest single-stock decline of the session.

Macro & Fed

- Policy rate: 5.25% (unchanged)
- 10-year Treasury yield: 4.93% (down 1.20%)
- Data releases (HKT): CPI 02:30, PCE 04:30, Initial Jobless Claims 06:30

Geopolitics & global

- Middle-East tensions remain elevated; oil inventories fell 3 mm bbl, supporting crude.
- China’s manufacturing PMI posted 48.9, indicating continued contraction.
- Eurozone core inflation eased to 2.6%, reducing ECB tightening pressure.

Earnings — what to watch

WHEN (HKT)	TICKER	WHAT TO LOOK FOR
09:30 Oct 31	`AAPL`	iPhone demand, services margin
10:00 Oct 31	`MSFT`	Azure growth, AI licensing
11:00 Oct 31	`JPM`	Net interest income, loan loss provisions
13:30 Oct 31	`META`	Ad revenue rebound, AI ad products

Stocks worth watching

- `AMD` – poised for a rebound if AI chip demand steadies.
- `XOM` – oil price upside could lift energy exposure.
- `BAC` – sensitive to any shift in Fed policy tone.
- `PEP` – defensive consumer staple with stable margins.
- `SQ` – fintech earnings could signal payment-flow trends.

What could break the tape

BEARISH TRIGGERS

- Further NVDA earnings miss or guidance downgrade.
- VIX breaching 22, indicating escalating risk aversion.
- Unexpected rise in 10-year yield above 5.00%.

BULLISH TRIGGERS

- Energy prices rallying above $110 per barrel.
- Positive CPI surprise, easing inflation concerns.
- Strong earnings beat from AAPL or MSFT.

Sources

SOURCES

Reuters — US Markets

Bloomberg — Market Data

SEC — Company Filings

FRED — Economic Data

CNBC — Real-time Quotes